

The Noble Victorious Crown Protrusion that Thoroughly Purifies All Lower Realms

Āryasarvadurgatipariśodhana Uṣṇīṣavijayā nāma dhāraṇī · Toh 597 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་དན་སངས་ཐད་ཡངས་ས་སྤྱོད་བ་གཙུག་ཏུ་རྣམ་པར་རྒྱ་བ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའ་གི་ཟུངས།

Toh 597 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Āryasarvadurgatipariśodhana Uṣṇīṣavijayā and in Tibetan as "The Noble Victorious Crown Protrusion that Thoroughly Purifies All Lower Realms." It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and centers on the powerful mantra of Uṣṇīṣavijayā, one of the most celebrated dhāraṇīs in the Buddhist tradition, renowned for its capacity to purify negative karma and liberate beings from lower rebirths. The text opens with a narrative frame set among the gods of the Thirty-Three, where a deity named Supraṭiṣṭhita receives a prophetic warning about his impending death and unfavorable rebirths, prompting the intervention of the Buddha, who reveals this dhāraṇī as a means of purification and protection. The inclusion of a detailed explanation alongside the dhāraṇī itself reflects the text's character as both a ritual and a doctrinal work, combining practical instruction with the soteriological promise of liberation from the lower realms.

Avalokiteśvara rejoiced and offered explicit praise. The noble dhāraṇī called "Victorious Crown Protrusion, Together with Its Explanation" is complete.

In the language of India: Āryasarvadurgatipariśodhana Uṣṇīṣavijayā nāma dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The dhāraṇī called "The Noble Victorious Crown Protrusion that Thoroughly Purifies All Lower Realms."

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Then there was a certain son of the gods named Supraṭiṣṭhita who dwelt among the gods of the Thirty-Three in the divine assembly hall of Sudharmā. In a great celestial palace, surrounded by a vast retinue of divine maidens and amid great divine pleasures, he was rejoicing and sporting in delight. While he was thus enjoying those divine pleasures, in the night he heard a voice say: "The son of the gods Supraṭiṣṭhita will meet his death in seven days' time. Having died, he will be reborn in Jambudvīpa, and there too he will pass through seven destinies. After passing through those seven destinies, he will be born in the hells. And if at some point in a hundred births he is born as a human, even then he will be poor and blind."

When he heard this, the son of the gods was struck with fear and terror and dread, his hair standing on end. In great distress he went to where Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods) was, and arriving there, he prostrated at Śakra's feet. Trembling and weeping and crying out "Alas! Alas!" he said these words to Śakra: "Lord of the gods, please listen. Lord of the gods, today, while I was surrounded by a retinue of divine maidens and experiencing the joy of divine pleasures in bliss and delight, I heard a voice say: 'The son of the gods Supraṭiṣṭhita will meet his death in seven days. He will be reborn in Jambudvīpa, and there too he will pass through seven destinies and be born in the hells. And if at some point in a hundred births he is born as a human, even then he will be poor and blind.' Having heard this, Lord of the gods, how am I to be saved?"

Then Śakra, upon hearing these words about the son of the gods Supraṭiṣṭhita, was filled with great wonder. Thinking about what seven destinies this son of the gods would pass through, he sat in silence. The seven destinies were: birth as a pig, a dog, a fox, a monkey, a venomous snake, a vulture, and a crow — these seven destinies, in which one would experience the eating of exceedingly impure things.

Then Śakra, having seen those seven destinies, thought: "Alas! This son of the gods is to experience immense and unbearable suffering. Who, other than a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly and fully awakened buddha, could become his refuge, his support, his ally?"

That very evening Śakra took incense, flowers, various fragrant offerings, garments, various ornaments, and the like, and went to where the Blessed One was. Arriving there, he prostrated with his head at the feet of the Blessed One, circumambulated him seven times, made a great offering, and then sat before the Blessed One. He presented in detail to the Blessed One the matter of the seven destinies of the son of the gods Supraṭiṣṭhita.

No sooner had Śakra finished presenting those seven destinies than from the crown protrusion of the Blessed One there issued forth rays of light of many colors.

Those rays illuminated all the realms and world-systems of the ten directions, and then, returning, they entered through the mouth of the Blessed One. Thereupon the Blessed One smiled and spoke thus to Śakra, lord of the gods: "Śakra, there is this dhāraṇī called the Uṣṇīṣavijaya — the Victorious Crown Protrusion — which the Tathāgata confers as an empowerment upon the crown

of the head. It completely purifies all lower destinies. It destroys all obscurations, all the sufferings of birth in miserable states. It completely purifies all the realms of hell-beings, the birthplaces of animals, and the world of Yama, lord of the dead. It establishes beings on the path to the higher destinies. Therefore, Śakra, the moment one hears this dhāraṇī called the Uṣṇīṣavijaya — which completely purifies all lower destinies — it destroys the many and varied sufferings that by their very nature lead to obscuration. One will attain a stream of existence purified through birth. Throughout all one's lifetimes one will remember those lives. One will pass from buddha-field to buddha-field. One will move from divine world to divine world, traversing all thirty-two divine abodes. Śakra, the very moment this is spoken, one who has accumulated karma that would otherwise cause one's life to be cut short will instead come to have one's life restored. Abiding in the experience of ease, one will dwell having accumulated pure actions of body, speech, and mind. All the Tathāgatas will look upon that person with care. They will always, without interruption, guard, protect, and shelter that person. All the bodhisattvas too will hold that person in mind. By the mere utterance of this, all the hells, the birthplaces of animals, the world of Yama, and all the realms of the hungry ghosts will be dried up, utterly destroyed, scattered, cleared away, and emptied. In this way, for that person, the gates of all buddha-fields, all divine abodes, and all the dwelling places of the bodhisattvas will be thrown open. Wherever that person wishes to go, they will be able to enter."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, please proclaim this dhāraṇī. Please set forth the medicine for the life of all sentient beings." Thereupon the Blessed One, knowing that Śakra had made this request, proclaimed these dhāraṇīs:

Namo ratnatrayāya. Oṃ namo bhagavate sarvatrailokyaprativiśiṣṭāya
buddhāya te namaḥ. Tadyathā: Oṃ bhrūṃ bhrūṃ bhrūṃ. Śodhaya śodhaya.
Viśodhaya viśodhaya. Asamasamanta-avabhāsa-spharaṇa-gati.
Gagana-svabhāva-viśuddhe. Abhiṣiñcantu māṃ.
Sarvatathāgata-sugata-vara-vācana. Amṛta-abhiṣekai. Mahāmudrā.
Mantrapadaiḥ. Āhara āhara. Mama āyusambhāraṇi. Śodhaya śodhaya.
Viśodhaya viśodhaya. Gagana-svabhāva-viśuddhe. Uṣṇīṣavijaya-pariśuddhe.
Sahasra-raśmi-saṅcodite. Sarvatathāgata-avalokani. Śaṭpāramitā-paripūraṇi.
Sarvatathāgata-māte daśabhūmi-pratiṣṭhite.
Sarvatathāgata-hṛdaya-adhiṣṭhāna-adhiṣṭhite. Mudre mudre. Mahāmudre.
Vajrakāya-saṃhatana. Pariśuddhe. Sarvakarma-āvaraṇa-viśuddhe.

Pratinivartaya. Mama āyur-viśuddhe. Sarvatathāgata-samaya-adhiṣṭhite. Oṃ muni muni. Mahāmuni. Vimuni vimuni. Mahāvimuni. Mati mati. Mahāmati. Mamati. Sumati. Tathatā. Bhūtakoti. Paśiśuddhe. Viśphuṭa. Buddhhe śuddhe. He he. Jaya jaya. Vijaya vijaya. Smara smara. Sphara sphara. Spharaya spharaya. Sarvabuddha-adhiṣṭhāna-adhiṣṭhite. Śuddhe śuddhe. Buddhhe buddhe. Vajre vajre.

Mahāvajre. Suvajre. Vajragarbhe. Jayagarbhe. Vijayagarbhe. Vajrajvālagarbhe. Vajrodbhave. Vajrasaṃbhave. Vajre vajriṇi. Vajrambhavatu. May my body and the bodies of all sentient beings become utterly pure. May all my destinies always be fully purified. Samantā namocaya mocaya. Adhiṣṭhāna. And may all the Tathāgatas console me. Buddhya buddhya. Sidhya sidhya. Bodhaya bodhaya. Vibodhaya vibodhaya. Mocaya mocaya. Vimocaya vimocaya. Śodhaya śodhaya. Viśodhaya viśodhaya. Samantarasmī paśiśuddhe. Sarvatathāgata-hṛdaya-adhiṣṭhāna-adhiṣṭhite. Mudre mudre. Mahāmudre. Mahāmudrā-mantra-pade. Svāhā.

This dhāraṇī called the Victorious Crown Ornament of Śakra (Indra, the Lord of Gods) — which entirely purifies all lower rebirths, which purifies all evils, karma, and obscurations, which leads along all the paths to happy destinies, and which destroys all lower rebirths — was spoken, blessed, and rejoiced over by buddhas, Blessed Ones, as numerous as the grains of sand in eighty-eight hundred-thousand-million Ganges rivers. It is sealed with the seal of the wisdom of all the Tathāgatas. It was taught so that all sentient beings may proceed to happy destinies; so that those who have fallen into lower rebirths may be turned back; and so that those who are suffering and wretched in all places of suffering — the hells, the realms of animals, the world of Yama the Lord of the Dead, and so forth — and those sentient beings who have fallen into the ocean of suffering may be fully liberated.

Likewise, this dhāraṇī was established in Jambudvīpa for the sake of sentient beings who are short-lived and of little merit, who are despised, whose intentions are degraded, and who have strayed from the path.

Śakra, Lord of Gods, take hold of this dhāraṇī and proclaim it to the son of the gods who is very steadfast. Having proclaimed it, apply yourself to its recitation aloud, its oral recitation, its contemplation, its meditation, its mindful remembrance, its veneration, its reception, and its thorough mastery. In this way, for the sake of the sons of the gods dwelling in all the divine realms, and for the sake, benefit, and happiness of the sentient beings of

Jambudvīpa, I entrust to you the seal and the secret mantras of this dhāraṇī. Therefore, Śakra, Lord of Gods, take and hold this. Śakra, Lord of Gods, the very moment this dhāraṇī is heard, the karmic obscurations accumulated over a thousand aeons will be entirely purified. Know that in birth after birth in all manner of forms, one will no longer be born in the hells, in the realms of animals, in the world of Yama, in the domain of hungry ghosts, among the class of asuras, or in such forms as yakṣas, rākṣasas (flesh-eating demons), elemental spirits, cannibals, putrid beings, beings with rotting bodies, bewildering spirits, dogs, tortoises, snakes, fierce predators, birds, insects, bees, venomous serpents, earthworms, and other such species of living creatures. Instead — with only the exception of being born to meet a Tathāgata or of being born in the family of bodhisattvas — I declare that one will be born in one of these great noble families: the brahmin class, like a great śāla tree; or the warrior-noble class, like a great śāla tree; or the merchant class, like a great śāla tree.

Śakra, Lord of Gods, such being the case, through the power of this dhāraṇī one attains, until arriving at the very heart of awakening, a thoroughly great purity of birth. Śakra, Lord of Gods, this dhāraṇī is thus of great power. Śakra, Lord of Gods, this dhāraṇī is of such great power, great benefit, great might, and is virtuous and auspicious.

Śakra, Lord of Gods, for the benefit of sentient beings, I have set forth this dhāraṇī called the Uṣṇīṣavijayā (the Victorious Crown Protrusion), which thoroughly purifies all lower rebirths.

Consider this example: a supremely stainless precious jewel, the very essence of sunlight, perfectly pure like the sky, luminous and clear, blazes with the radiance of its rays as it rests there. In just the same way, Śakra, Lord of Gods, that sentient being too should be understood to be without stain.

Or consider this further example: the gold of the Jambu River is stainless, supremely pure, exceedingly malleable, and exceedingly beautiful. In just the same way, Śakra, Lord of Gods, that sentient being too should be understood to be supremely pure, and in other lives as well they will be born in that same manner.

Śakra, Lord of Gods, wherever this dhāraṇī is taught openly, and in particular wherever one undertakes to transcribe it in letters, to hold it, to read it, to recite it, to chant it, to venerate it, to make it perfect, to listen to it, and to retain it — in that place all beings will be thoroughly purified, and all continuity

of the hells for sentient beings will be cut off.

Śakra, Lord of Gods, this dhāraṇī should be written down and placed upon the summit of a victory banner, or upon a high mountain, or upon a high building, or atop the life-pole of a stūpa.

Śakra, Lord of Gods, if any monk, nun, layman, laywoman, or son or daughter of good family of some other class should see it placed upon the summit of a victory banner, or should come to dwell in proximity to that place, and even if only its shadow falls upon them, or if the wind bearing its dust should touch them — then, Śakra, Lord of Gods, not one of all the misdeeds of that sentient being nor any of the fears of falling into lower rebirths will arise for them. They will not be born in any of the hells, in the realm of animals, in the world of Yama, among the hungry ghosts, or among the asuras.

Śakra, Lord of Gods, know that sentient being to have been prophesied by all the Tathāgatas, and to be irreversibly set upon unsurpassed, complete, and perfect awakening.

Śakra, Lord of Gods, what need is there to speak at length? If one makes offerings and acts of homage with flowers, incense, perfume, garland offerings, ointments, parasols, victory banners, pennants, and ornaments of all kinds; if one erects a stūpa at a crossroads and places this dhāraṇī within it; if one joins one's palms in reverence before it, or prostrates to it, or circumambulates it — then, Śakra, Lord of Gods, know that sentient being to be a great being. Know them to be a child of the Tathāgata. Know them to be an abode of the Dharma. Know them to be a stūpa of the Tathāgata.

Then Yama, the Dharma King and lord of the dead, rose at midnight and went to where the Blessed One was. He made offerings to the Blessed One with divine flowers, garments, ornaments, and the like, and rendered him homage. He circumambulated the Blessed One seven times, then touched his head to the feet of the Blessed One and spoke these words: "Blessed One, this dhāraṇī is of great power and great benefit. I too, Blessed One, will continuously and without interruption follow behind that sentient being, protect them on all sides, guard them fully, and remain as their shelter. I will turn them back from all the hells. Blessed One, I will repay what has been done, and I will not fail to repay what has been done."

Then the Four Great Kings circumambulated the Blessed One three times and spoke to him thus: "Blessed One, the detailed ritual procedure of this dhāraṇī, and —"

"Please explain in detail the ritual procedure for performing it."

Then the Blessed One spoke to the Four Great Kings in these words: "Listen, and I shall explain the method of performing this dhāraṇī.

For the sake of a sentient being whose life is short, a son or daughter of good family should bathe on the fifteenth day of the waxing moon and recite this dhāraṇī one thousand and eight times. By doing so, that sentient being whose life is spent will recover, and will be freed from every illness. They will attain the complete purification of all obscurations. They will be fully liberated from all the lower destinies such as the hells.

Moreover, even for a creature born in the animal realm, one should proclaim the sound of this dhāraṇī in its ear — know that this will be the last of its lower rebirths.

One who has been struck by a great illness and whom physicians have examined and diagnosed will also be completely freed from that illness. All births in the lower destinies will be severed without remainder. After death, they will be born in the world-realm of Bliss — the pure land Sukhāvatī. Know that this will be the last womb-birth for that being. In whatever place they are born after that, they will arise miraculously from within the heart of a lotus alone. In every lifetime, they will remember their past lives.

For the sake of sentient beings who have committed misdeeds and have died, one should recite this dhāraṇī over white mustard seeds twenty-one times in full, then scatter them over the bones of those beings. Even if they have been born in a hell, in an animal realm, in the realm of Yama's world below, as a hungry ghost, or in any other lower destiny, by the power of this dhāraṇī they will be liberated from those lower destinies. Having been freed from those, they will be reborn among the gods.

Whoever recites this dhāraṇī twenty-one times each day will become worthy of the veneration of many worlds. Their life will be long. They will experience happiness. They will always be filled with joy, and they will attain great nirvāṇa. After death they will be born in the world-realm Sukhāvatī. From there they will journey through the many various buddha-fields. There too they will meet all the Tathāgatas. All the Tathāgatas will give them comfort. All the Tathāgatas will give them prophecies of awakening. In all buddha-fields they will illuminate the world.

O Śakra, lord of the gods — Indra — by this method, all beings will be fully liberated from every destiny, including the hells and all other lower rebirths. Through this, all beings will be completely purified and their lives will be long.

O Śakra, lord of the gods, go now and teach this dhāraṇī to the divine son Susthitamati and proclaim it to him. O Śakra, lord of the gods, within seven days, all the beings of the divine son Susthitamati will be completely purified, their lives will be long, and they will become powerful."

Then Śakra, the lord of the gods, received this instruction from the Tathāgata, went to that place, and gave this dhāraṇī to the divine son Susthitamati. That divine son then, through six days and six nights up to the seventh day, diligently practiced this dhāraṇī. All his wishes were magnificently fulfilled, such that he joyfully exclaimed aloud again and again:

"Fully freed from the lower destinies,
I dwell upon the path of happy rebirths.
My life has grown long —
How wondrous, the buddhas!
How wondrous, the Dharma!
How wondrous that such a dhāraṇī as this has arisen in the world,
By which I have been completely liberated from great fear!"

[illegible]

Translator's Notes

- The colophon at the opening marks the conclusion of a prior dhāraṇī text ("Victorious Crown Protrusion Together with Its Explanation"), and what follows is the opening of a new but closely related text: the Āryasarvadurgatipariśodhana Uṣṇīṣavijayā dhāraṇī, one of the most widely attested dhāraṇī texts in the Tibetan canon. The title is given first in Sanskrit transliteration and then in Tibetan, as is standard for canonical texts in this tradition.

The "Thirty-Three" refers to the Trāyastriṃśa heaven, the realm of the thirty-three gods presided over by Śakra. Sudharmā is the name of the divine assembly hall in that heaven. Supraṭiṣṭhita is the standard Sanskrit reconstruction for the Tibetan name Shin tu brtan pa, meaning "Firmly Established."

- The dhāraṇī text is reproduced as phonetic Sanskrit transliterated from the Tibetan, following standard practice for such liturgical passages. Minor variations from Sanskrit canonical editions of the Uṣṇīṣavijaya-dhāraṇī are expected given the conventions of Tibetan phonetic transcription and should not be treated as errors in the translation. The phrase rendered "the medicine for the life of all sentient beings" translates a phrase meaning a healing or remedying

of the lifespan of all sentient beings, which is the central soteriological function of this dhāraṇī as described throughout the text. The thirty-two divine abodes refer to the standard enumeration of divine realms within the cosmological scheme; the exact referent can vary between cosmological systems, and this is noted as a possible source of interpretive variation.

- The mantra syllables in the opening section are rendered in their Indic form as they appear transliterated in the Tibetan, consistent with the preceding passage, and are not translated since they function as dhāraṇī syllables. The phrase "samantarasmī pariśuddhe" is a slight variation of the earlier "samantarasmī" formula and is treated accordingly.

The image of the three noble families compared to "a great śāla tree" reflects the traditional simile of the śāla tree as the most majestic and towering of trees, signifying the highest and most honorable station within each social class. This is a standard formulaic expression in this type of dhāranī literature.

- The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end, as the source text ends with an incomplete phrase. This has been rendered faithfully as a trailing construction leading into what would follow in the next passage.

The epithet "འདུན་པའི་ལམ་ལུགས་ཀྱི་རྒྱལ་པོ་" (Dharma King Yama) refers to Yama, lord of the dead and judge of karmic accounts in the Indo-Tibetan cosmological tradition. The text presents him here as a devotee making offerings to the Buddha, consistent with the sūtra genre's incorporation of cosmological figures as interlocutors.

- The phrase rendered "realm of Yama's world below" translates a compound that literally indicates the world of the lord of the dead (Yama). This is listed alongside hells, animals, and hungry ghosts as a distinct lower state, which likely refers to the preta realm under Yama's dominion, though some traditions treat it as a subdivision of hell.

The exclamation "Ā la la" is a classical Tibetan expression of joy and wonder, analogous to Sanskrit "aho." It is here rendered as "How wondrous" to convey its emotional register naturally in speech.

The name Susthitamati ("Firm Intellect" or "Well-Established Mind") is the Sanskrit reconstruction of the Tibetan Lhé bu Shin tu brtan pa, meaning "the divine son of very firm mind." It is kept in its Sanskrit form for consistency.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.